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Summary:

- Established and maintained trustful relationships with executive teams, boards, business stakeholders, and customers
- Translated business vision into a technology strategy and conducted end-to-end execution.
- 8 years of experience in building and supporting high performing agile teams (remote and on-site). Proven ability to motivate and guide teams towards the shared product vision
- 20+ years of hands-on experience in business and system analysis, software design and development
- Mentored and support people, defined professional development paths, fostered engagement and motivation
- Guided teams to implement mature development practices, while continuously enhancing alignment, efficiency, and quality
- Directed implementation of best engineering practices like TDD, CI/CD, Infrastructure as a code, shifting quality to left, pair and mob programming, agile, and data-driven experiments

Recent experience:

Te Kete Hono

April 2020 – present

Head of technology

(Contract)

Te Kete Hono is a social impact enterprise backed by Hugh Green foundation. Its mission is to accelerate learning in schools by implementing cutting edge technology and pedagogy practices.

Achievements

- Established and maintained a technology governance framework to drive development excellence of 3 SaaS products
- Organised a highly innovative, self-organising, and results-driven team of 6 technology experts
- Prepared data privacy and security policies, terms of use and code of conduct protecting the data of 10000+ users
- Improved customer satisfaction by transitioning to microservice architecture improving average response times by 30% and by 75% during peak hours
- Planned and executed infrastructure modernisation and migration to a different Cloud Provider reducing operational costs by 50%
- Implemented Secure Development Life Cycle practices and passed an external security audit with zero risks reported and 100% compliance rating achieved
- Orchestrated the on-time and under-budget launch of an ed-tech product, utilising agile methodologies to streamline development and reduce time-to-market by 25%

Responsibilities:

- Developed strategic technology vision and 3 year rolling development roadmap for product and component ecosystem aligned with business objectives
- Directed Operational Management by overseeing the performance and scalability of 3 SaaS products
- Co-ordinated the financial management of all aspects of technology to ensure optimal costs
- Owned all aspects of the relationship with third party vendors and partners
- Managed stakeholder and the Board relationship and communication to ensure efficient development, implementation and maintenance of systems

- Developed and deliver the annual marketing and sales plan
- Drived change in team's culture and ways of work to create company wide high trust environment
- Guided the team to raise maturity of their development practices
- Advised team members on the best career development opportunities and the best ways to stretch their skills

Technology stack:

JavaScript ES6, React, Material UI, Webpack Module Federation, Jest, React Testing Library; C#.Net, Azure Functions, Entity Framework; SQL Server, Cosmos DB, Azure Tables, Queues and Blob Storage; Azure DevOps, git, CI/CD pipelines, YAML; SonarCloud;

Serko

Software engineering manager

Aug 2019 – Apr 2020

(Contract)

Serko is a technology company which offers intelligent corporate travel and expense solutions. It controlled more than 70% of the corporate travel market in New Zealand and Australia.

Achievements

- Built a tightly knit team of 6 developers
- Created a safe, open culture to stimulate collaboration across 5 teams
- Coached developers, promoted knowledge sharing, increased performance of the team by 50% (pair programming and mobbing)
- Reduced error rates on critical pathways by 90%
- Promoted a 'build it and own it' mindset where developers own 100% of software development life cycle of the code they have developed

Led the following streams of work:

- Stabilisation of the platform
- Development of AI capabilities

Responsibilities - people leadership:

- Fostered a safe and productive environment for teams (can-do attitude, mutual support, fail fast, learn from mistakes, manage risks, seek opportunities to innovate, seek feedback)

- Guided teams to stabilise the product (create visibility of production issues, remove the fear of deployment, raise the maturity of development practices, and improve code quality).
- Collaborated with the product team to define roadmaps and manage customer expectations
- Facilitated shifting company-wide culture from “startup” to “scale up” mentality, realigning team structure to product and business objectives, modernising architecture of the product

Responsibilities - technical leadership:

- Created architecture proposals, and communicating such within the organisation
- Communicated expectations related to product performance, reliability, and security
- Promoted tools like TDD, CI/CD, Infrastructure as a code, shifting quality to left, pair and mob programming, scrum
- Reviewed solution design against technical vision and redirecting delivery teams where necessary, conceiving strategies to counter product technical debt

Technology stack:

React/Redux, HTML5, CSS3, Javascript/Typescript, Node.js, c# .Net, Azure Cloud, Azure Devops, App Insights, SQL Server, LUIS, Uneeq (digitalhumans.com)

Propellerhead. Product owner / development manager

Oct 2017 – Nov 2019

(Contract)

Propellerhead is a digital partner that helps businesses to make pragmatic and cost efficient technology decisions. During my time at Propellerhead, I navigated rapidly changing priorities and allocated limited development resources to ensure that we were delivering value to our clients. Managing clients with various backgrounds, including government, commercial, and startups.

I had to adapt my collaboration style to meet their unique needs. I was guiding three software development teams, both remote and on site, I coordinated the efforts of 10 third-party vendors both locally and overseas.

Led the following streams of work:

- Identity migration for a group of 10 corporate websites
- Creation of MVP for a NZ based AML startup on time and budget
- Design and development of professional learning and development system
- Video streaming platform prototype for a NZ leading rugby team
- Implementation of Silverstripe content management system for NZ leading rugby team

Responsibilities - product development:

- Liaised with client stakeholders to define product vision and product roadmap
- Collaborated with the client to prioritise product deliverables
- Drafted and prioritised user stories for the product backlog
- Liaised with client stakeholders - communicated product vision and progress towards that vision
- Managed expectations, coordinated deliverables with 10 vendors
- Guided 3 teams in different locations

Responsibilities - technical leadership:

- Developed product architecture and technical vision, and communicated such both within the organisation and to clients
- Communicated expectations related to product performance, reliability, and security
- Improved delivery team quality through the establishment and maintenance of technical practices
- Reviewed solution design against technical vision and directed delivery teams where necessary
- Conceived strategies to counter product technical debt
- Collaborated with partners and distributed development resource

Technology stack:

Azure, AWS, React/Redux, HTML5, CSS3, JavaScript/TypeScript, Node.js, c# .Net, mySQL, MongoDB, Azure Tables, Cosmos DB, Auth0

Schooltalk Co-founder / Software engineering manager

Jan 2015 – Sept 2017

SchoolTalk is a social impact startup that developed a software platform to help teachers track student progress, monitor engagement, and assess achievement based on evidence, including student self-assessment. Ongoing evaluation of SchoolTalk has shown that it has a consistent positive impact on teaching practices and student learning outcomes, particularly for students from Māori and Pacific backgrounds.

Responsibilities - product development:

- Performed market research and market validation of the product
- Liaised in a consultative fashion with domain experts and define the product requirements

- Shaped and prioritise product features
- Identified, prototyped and prioritised technologies, platforms and third-party services most suitable to meet product requirements
- Directed front-end and back-end development
- Performed testing, deployment and support tasks
- Created and conducted end-user and pre-sales presentations

Responsibilities - project leadership:

- Identified funding opportunities and prepare grant documentation
- Lead time and cost estimation to provide realistic delivery forecast
- Assessed risks before production releases and patches
- Managed the development team using Agile methodologies to ensure the quality of software and timely delivery
- Organised regular demonstrations of in-sprint progress
- Guided solution architecture design
- Supervised implementation process
- Interviewed and hired new team members

Technology stack:

JavaScript, React.JS, Loki.JS, Ajax, jQuery, HTML5, CSS3, Google Material Design, C#, ASP.Net MVC 5, Entity Framework, Azure App Services and Web Jobs, AWS Lambda functions, OWIN Authentication, Google Drive and Google Directory Integration, SQL Server, T-SQL, Azure Blob Storage and Table Storage

Previous experience (2001 - 2015)

- 2013 - 2014 Senior Full Stack Software Developer at Fraedom.com
- 2007 - 2013 Senior Analyst / Programmer at Freightways
- 2006 - 2007 Senior Analyst / Programmer at Thor United
- 2001 - 2005 Analyst / Programmer at Sportmaster.com

Summary of software development skills

- Created architectural plans outlined the structure of the new software solutions
- Engineered Web Applications and Web Services

- Integrated applications with third-party payment and authentication services using public APIs
- Implemented Single Sign-On mechanisms with trusted parties
- Developed data schemas and stored procedures, performed data migration.
- Performed code reviews
- Tested and deployed software updates to production environments

Summary of technical leadership skills:

- Coached new team members, mentored junior developers
- Created technical documentation and “how-to” articles for developers
- Compiled project schedules, distributed tasks over developers
- Reported to senior management about the course of the project
- Managed records for audit and customer billing
- Presented the systems to stakeholders and end-users
- Facilitated agile software development practices

Summary of system and business analysis skills

- Engaged with key stakeholders to define functional requirements
- Documented business processes, defined business and system requirements
- Designed solutions, defined approaches for implementation, evaluated and selected the most suitable one.
- Designed onboarding procedures for users including user training materials and user training sessions

Summary of completed projects

- Total Travel and Expense Solution for Freedom
- Redesign of core Track and Trace services for Freightways
- [Courier Card Left service](#) for New Zealand Couriers
- [Courier Card Left service](#) for Post Haste
- [Courier Card Left service](#) for Castle Parcels
- [Courier Card Left service](#) for Pass The Parcel
- Courier Cards Software Package for Freightways
- In-Depot Consignment Scanning for Freightways

- Australia Post Returns Management for Freightways
- Debtors Ledger Transaction Posting and End-of-Period Jobs for Freightways
- Payroll Processing for Thor United
- Consultant Payroll System for Thor United
- International Logistics – Shipment Tracking and Management for Sportmaster
- International Logistics – Fiscal Accounting for Sportmaster

Technology stack

C#/ VB.Net, ASP.Net MVC, CSS3, HTML5, jQuery, JavaScript, Ajax, Delphi 6.0, VBA, WCF, ASP.Net Web services, Windows services, TFS, SVN, nHibernate, ORACLE 10g, SQL Server, Reporting Services, MS Access, MS Excel, XML, XSD, Visio, Er-Win, UML, N-Doc, HTML Help Workshop

Education:

- Postgraduate Diploma in Information Technology and Computer Science (Auckland University of Technology)
- Postgraduate Diploma in Business Analysis (Russian Academy of National Economy)
- Master of Applied Physics and Mathematics (Moscow Institute of Physics and Technology)